# Chapter 2 Phrases and Vocabulary for the Speaking Section with Reference to Skill and Purpose

The phrases and words in each category can frequently be interchanged. Look at the sample essays, and pay attention to the context in which the phrases and words are used. You will get a good idea of when and how to use them.

**Speaking 1 (S1) To Hesitate (to give yourself more time to think)**

- **Let's see**
- **That's an interesting/a good question**
- **Let me think**
- **That's a good question**

**Speaking 2 (S2) To Give an Opinion**

- **(Why) I believe**
- **I'd like to explain why**



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- **Personally**
- **I'd enjoy**
- **I would prefer/be**
- **I think**
- **In my opinion**
- **As far as I'm concerned**
- **It seems to me**
- **I'd/He feel/feels**

**Speaking 3 (S3) To Set Up a Condition**

- **If**
- **Even if**
- **If I could**
- **Whether (or not) to**
- **. . . as though**

**Speaking 4 (S4) To Further the Argument**

- **First (of all) . . . Second . . . Third**
- **In addition**
- **There are (three) reasons why**
- **Similarly**
- **Furthermore**
- **Moreover**
- **Further**
- **As an example**
- **For instance**



- **What's more**
- **. . . a good idea**
- **. . . in favor of**

**Speaking 5 (S5) To Summarize/Conclude**

- **In conclusion**
- **Finally**
- **As a result**
- **In summary**
- **Therefore**
- **To sum up**
- **In other words**
- **To summarize**
- **Then**
- **In brief**
- **On the whole**
- **To conclude**
- **As we have seen,**
- **As has been said,**
- **Thereby**
- **Most importantly**

**Speaking 6 (S6) To Show Ability**

- **(I'd be) able to**
- **I can/could**
- **I'm able to**

- **I'd be capable of**
- **. . . enables**

**Speaking 7 (S7) To Show Cause/Reason and Effect/Result**

- **As a result**
- **Consequently**
- **Because (of)**
- **Due to**
- **Thanks to**
- **If this occurs, then**
- **To this end**
- **Since**
- **For this reason**

**Speaking 8 (S8) To Show Time Relationships**

- **Immediately**
- **Then**
- **Later**
- **Afterwards**
- **After**
- **Before**
- **While**
- **During**
- **As soon as**
- **As**



- **Sometimes**
- **When**
- **Ever/Never**
- **Every day/month/year**

**Speaking 9 (S9) To Generalize**

- **Overall**
- **For the most part**
- **In general**
- **Generally speaking**
- **By and large**

**Speaking 10 (S10) To Show Contrast**

- **Some may argue that**
- **Although**
- **Even though**
- **Whereas**
- **While**
- **Instead**
- **In contrast**
- **On the one hand**
- **On the other hand**
- **However**
- **In spite of**
- **Despite**

- **Unlike**
- **On the contrary**
- **But**
- **Neither/nor**
- **. . . rather than**
- **. . . mistakenly**
- **Curiously**
- **Not until**
- **Surprisingly**

**Speaking 11 (S11)  To Show Emphasis**

- **Above all**
- **Obviously**
- **Clearly**
- **Evidently**
- **Actually**
- **In fact**
- **Certainly**
- **Definitely**
- **Extremely**
- **Indeed**
- **Absolutely**
- **Positively**
- **Unquestionably**
- **Without a doubt**



**Speaking 12 (S12) To State Policy**

- **The policy is (that)**
- **The policy states**

**Speaking 13 (S13) To Argue a Point/Make a Suggestion**

- **. . . seems to warrant**
- **. . . contends**
- **. . . argues**
- **. . . justifies**
- **This observation is supported by**
- **. . . to plead**
- **. . . suggests**
- **The suggestion is valid**
- **. . . proposes**
- **Both . . . and**
- **Also**
- **. . . claims**
- **. . . states**
- **The suggestion is**
- **Not only . . . but also**
- **There are benefits**

**Speaking 14 (S14) To Show Disagreement**

- **. . . objects (to)**
- **. . . disagrees with**



- **. . . opposes**
- **. . . contradicts**
- **. . . are invalid**
- **Others may argue**

**Speaking 15 (S15) To Choose one Option Over Another**

- **. . . might be/is the better option**
- **. . . makes it a better policy**
- **. . . is the better alternative**

**Speaking 16 (S16) To Show Similarity**

- **Just as**
- **As . . . as**
- **In the same way**
- **Similarly**
- **Likewise**
- **As in/as with/as was/etc.**
- **Like**

**Speaking 17 (S17) To Show Purpose**

- **In order to**
- **For**
- **So that**
- **So as to**
- **. . . compensation for**



**Speaking 18 (S18) To Show Evidence/Give an Example**

- **As evidence of**
- **The legitimacy of**
- **Such as**
- **For example**
- **A few of these are**
- **In the case of**
- **In addition (to)**
- **For one thing . . . for another**

**Speaking 19 (S19) To State the Problem**

- **The problem is (how)**

**Speaking 20 (S20) To State the Options**

- **She is considering two (various) options**
- **One option is**
- **The other option is**
- **. . . might/may be an/the easier /better option**
- **. . . has (two) alternatives**